TEKREVOL



BUSINESS CASE KIT

Business case kit

For custom software investments · 2026 edition

Who this kit is for

You've found a problem that software could fix: a process that eats hours, a system that's holding the business back, or a product your customers need. Now you need approval from people who weren't in the room.

This kit helps you make that case. Use it whether you work with TekRevol or not.

What's inside

1. A one-page business case template
2. What custom software costs, and what moves the price
3. An ROI worksheet with a worked example
4. Build, buy or connect: a quick test
5. Vendor evaluation checklist
6. Security and ownership questions your approvers will ask
7. How TekRevol works, in one page

1. One-page business case template

Approvers read one page. Keep each section to two or three lines.

Section	What to write
The problem	What isn't working, in business terms. "Orders are entered three times" beats "the system is outdated"
What it costs today	Hours per week, error rate, delays, lost sales, risk. Use the ROI worksheet (section 3)
The cost of waiting	What happens in 12 months if nothing changes: more headcount, more errors, a growth target missed
What we propose	The solution in one sentence, plus the first stage
Options we considered	Doing nothing, an off-the-shelf tool, connecting what we have, building custom. One line on why each was or wasn't chosen
Cost and timeline	Planning range and time to first working release. Show the phases, so approval can be staged
Expected return	Annual savings or gains, and the payback period
Risks and how we'll manage them	Two or three, each with a response
The ask	What you need approved now. Often just discovery, not the whole project

Tip: ask for approval of the first stage, not the full budget. A paid discovery with a fixed quote at the end is an easier yes, and it gives your approvers real numbers.

2. What custom software costs

Planning ranges for US companies working with a full-service software development partner. `CONFIRM` all ranges with TekRevol sales before publishing.

Project type	Typical range	Time to first release	Full timeline
Internal tool or workflow app	[$35,000 to $70,000]	8 to 12 weeks	3 to 4 months
Business system (quoting, operations, ERP or CRM extension)	[$50,000 to $120,000]	10 to 16 weeks	4 to 9 months
Customer portal or web app	[$50,000 to $150,000]	10 to 16 weeks	4 to 8 months
Mobile app (iOS and Android)	[$60,000 to $180,000]	12 to 16 weeks	4 to 9 months
System integration	[$25,000 to $80,000]	6 to 10 weeks	2 to 4 months
Legacy modernization (in stages)	[$120,000 to $350,000+]	12 to 20 weeks per stage	9 to 18 months
Dedicated team	[Monthly, per team]	Starts in [2 to 4] weeks	Ongoing

What moves the price

- **Integrations:** each system you connect adds work, more if it has no documented API
- **User roles and permissions:** three roles is simple; fifteen is not
- **Platforms:** web, iOS and Android each add design, build and testing
- **Compliance:** HIPAA, PCI DSS or SOC 2 controls add security work and documentation
- **Data migration:** moving years of history from old systems
- **Certainty:** a clear, stable scope costs less than one that changes every sprint

3. ROI worksheet

Fill in your own numbers. Conservative inputs make a stronger case than optimistic ones.

Line	Input	Your number
A	Hours per week spent on the manual process (all people)	

Line	Input	Your number
B	Fully loaded hourly cost (salary + benefits + overhead)	
C	Share of those hours the software removes (be conservative: 50 to 70%)	
D	**Annual time savings** = A × B × C × 48 weeks	
E	Annual cost of errors today (rework, refunds, write-offs)	
F	Share of errors the software prevents	
G	**Annual error savings** = E × F	
H	Licenses or tools you can retire, per year	
I	Added revenue (faster quotes, more capacity), if you can defend it	
J	**Total annual benefit** = D + G + H + I	
K	Project cost (planning range, upper end)	
L	Annual support and hosting	
M	**Payback period in months** = K ÷ (J − L) × 12	

Worked example (illustrative numbers, not a client result)

A distributor with 120 employees re-keys orders between its order system and accounting.

Line	Value
A. Hours per week	30
B. Hourly cost	$45
C. Share removed	70%
D. Annual time savings	30 × 45 × 0.7 × 48 = **$45,360**
E. Annual cost of errors	$30,000
F. Share prevented	60%
G. Annual error savings	**$18,000**
H. Retired tools	$4,000
I. Added revenue	$0 (left out to stay conservative)
J. Total annual benefit	**$67,360**
K. Project cost	$80,000
L. Support and hosting	$12,000
M. Payback	80,000 ÷ 55,360 × 12 = **about 17 months**

4. Build, buy or connect: a quick test

If this is true	Consider
A standard tool covers 80% or more of what you need, and the rest can change	**Buy**
Your tools are fine, but data is typed into several of them	**Connect**
The workflow is how you win business, and no tool fits it	**Build**
Your core system works but is slow, costly or hard to change	**Modernize in stages**
You're paying for workarounds: extra headcount, spreadsheets, manual reports	**Build or connect**

Many companies end up with a mix: off-the-shelf tools for standard work, custom software for what makes them different, and integration in between.

5. Vendor evaluation checklist

Ask every vendor the same questions, including us.

Delivery

- Will we see working software every two weeks, or only status reports?
- Who is our single point of contact, and how senior are they?
- Who signs off that a release is ready for production, and against what checklist?
- Can we speak to two clients with a similar project?

Cost

- Do you publish price ranges? Do you give a fixed quote, and when?
- What happens if scope changes mid-project?
- What does support cost after launch?

Ownership

- Do we own the source code and IP from the first commit?
- Will you sign an NDA before discovery?
- If we part ways, what do we get: code, documentation, credentials?

Security

- Which certifications do you hold, and which standards do you have experience with?
- How do you handle our data and access to our systems?
- How are security checks built into your development process?

6. Security and ownership questions your approvers will ask

`CONFIRM` every line with TekRevol delivery and IT before publishing.

Question	TekRevol's answer
Who owns the code and IP?	You do, from the first commit
Do you sign an NDA?	Yes, before discovery
Which certifications do you hold?	[List formal certifications, e.g. ISO 27001, SOC 2, or state "none yet"]
Which compliance standards have you built for?	HIPAA, PCI DSS and GDPR environments (experience, not certification)
How is access to our systems controlled?	[Named accounts, least-privilege access, removed at project end]
Where does our data live?	[In your cloud accounts where possible; no production data on personal devices]
How is security checked?	At every Ship Line review, against the Build Standard: code review, dependency scanning, access control, encryption
What do we get at handover?	Source code, documentation, credentials and a handover session

7. How TekRevol works, in one page

TekRevol is a software development company. We design, build and support custom software, web and mobile apps for growing and mid-sized companies. Since 2018 `CONFIRM`.

The Strata Method: explore fast, ship deliberately.

- **Explore:** discovery, prototypes and options, quick and inexpensive to change
- **The Ship Line:** nothing goes to production until it passes the Build Standard, with a named owner and a written sign-off you can see
- **Ship:** working software every two weeks, then support and evolution after launch

The Build Standard checks five layers at every Ship Line: experience (usability, accessibility), product logic (code review, automated tests), AI features where used (evaluated, data kept private), data (privacy, backups), infrastructure (monitoring, uptime, cost controls). `CONFIRM`

Commitments: you own the code and IP · NDA before discovery · sprint reviews every two weeks · one accountable lead `CONFIRM`

Ready for real numbers?

Get a project estimate. Tell us what you need, and within 3 business days you get a written estimate: cost range, timeline, team and what to build first. Built to drop straight into section 1 of this kit.

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